

Bookmark 6 — Morning after Nightstone / Breakfast at Morak's Inn

Timestamp: 11:40pm, Monday 27 April 2025

Campaign: *Storm King's Thunder* — Dubbo table

Current scene pause: Morak's inn, morning after the Dripping Caves rescue, before departure toward Goldenfields / Tower of Zephyros.

1. Current exact pause point

The party is seated at Morak's inn for a quiet breakfast.

Alphie woke before the others and made a proper hot meal without announcing it:

- cider oat porridge with apples, dried apple, walnuts, honey, and pear-apple cider;
- toasted village bread;
- scrambled eggs with onion, hard cheese, and smoked ham strips;
- weak black tea with dried mint.

Morak allowed Alphie to use:

- 9 eggs;
- one stale but usable village loaf;
- oats;
- bruised apples;
- onions;
- half the hard cheese;
- tea and dried mint;
- hearth and pan.

Morak warned:

“If you burn my pan, Roane, I'll add it to the horse debt.”

Alphie was careful.

Current mood: quiet, warm, post-trauma, restorative. No decisions yet. No one is pushing the next quest. Breakfast itself is the scene.

Wren came down first, wrapped in a blanket. Alphie slid her bowl across the table and said:

“There's honey if you want it.”

Wren noticed the cider in the oats and simply said:

“Oh.”

Kella came down next, checked exits, asked if the food was poisoned. Alphie said:

“Noted. File updated.”

Kella tasted the food and called it:

“Acceptable.”

Wren translated that as gratitude; Kella corrected:

“That was praise.”

Dorrin came down fully dressed, already composed. He recognised the act as care. He said only:

“Good.”

Morak topped up hot water without comment.

The final line of the scene:

Outside, Nightstone wakes slowly.

Inside, for a few minutes, nobody asks for decisions, oaths, debts, letters, or courage.

Breakfast is enough.

2. Source-correct campaign position

The party has finished Chapter 1's Nightstone / Dripping Caves arc and returned safely. Source-correct next steps:

1. Characters who survive Dripping Caves and return to Nightstone advance to **level 4**.
2. Morak takes stock and asks the party to carry one of three sad-news quests:
 - Bryn Shander: news of Semile Southwell's death to Markham Southwell.
 - Goldenfields: news of Lathan and Melantha Xelbrin's deaths to Miros Xelbrin, plus Rillix if alive.
 - Triboar: news of Darthag Ulgar's death to Alaestra Ulgar.
3. Party chose **Goldenfields**.
4. The **Tower of Zephyros** happens **the day after** the party accepts Morak's quest, not immediately.

Current table position: the party has accepted Goldenfields and has secured Rillix. We are at the quiet morning before the next big source beat.

3. Active party

Alphie / Alfie J. Roane — Josh

Human noble wizard, level 4.

Core identity:

- House Roane noble / cider-trade family.
- Ledger-minded, lawful, oath-focused, gentle when he can be, pragmatic when he must be.
- Speaks Giant, which mattered critically with the ogres.
- Wants his father's name carried rightly.
- Has become the party's public negotiator and coalition-maker.

Recent defining acts:

- Negotiated with Xolkin rather than fighting.
- Witnessed and structured public oaths.
- Defended Nightstone from the Ear Seekers.
- Killed Gurrash with Fire Bolt.
- Negotiated Hark's surrender / safe passage.
- Spoke Giant to the ogres and traded six Nightstone horses for the safe release of villagers.
- Made restitution for the horse debt.
- Asked Morak to tell travellers four names: **Alphie Roane, Wren, Dorrin Stonebrook, Kella** — not heroically, just by name, for his father.
- Made breakfast quietly for Wren, Kella, and Dorrin.

Important unresolved mechanical issue:

- Table has been running **2014 5e**, with Alphie as **Divination Wizard**.
- Josh's D&D Beyond screenshots showed a **2024 Evocation Wizard** build.
- Before next combat, Marcus needs to lock whether the table is using:
 - 2014 Divination build, or
 - D&D Beyond 2024 Evocation build,
 - or some deliberate conversion.

This should be resolved before Tower of Zephyros travel leads into Chapter 2 danger.

Wren — Talia

Bard, level 4.

Core identity:

- Warm, observant, emotionally perceptive.
- Often sees the hidden heart of a story before others do.
- Has growing emotional closeness with Alphie.
- Has a charged and interesting dynamic with Kella.
- Helped Rillix trust the party.
- Likely now has Rillix perched or bonded most closely to her.

Recent key beats:

- Played music at the Nightstone survivor gathering.
- Asked Kella the question that cracked open her story about the magistrate's ledger and her father.
- Was the first down to Alphie's breakfast.
- Reacted with quiet tenderness to the cider oats.

Potential relationship thread:

- Wren and Alphie have the warmest and healthiest slow-burn romance potential, but only if Talia wants it.
- Wren is also emotionally connected to Kella's moral tension and should have agency in whether Kella becomes close to the party.

Dorrin Stonebrook — Ben

Hill dwarf cleric of Berronar Truesilver, level 4.

Core identity:

- Moral anchor.
- Hearth, family, oaths, protection.
- Not naïve, not passive.
- Understands costly mercy.
- Often says very little, but when he speaks, it matters.

Recent key beats:

- Witnessed Xolkin's oath.
- Healed Kaelen.
- Healed Sydiri.
- Held Bless during critical negotiations and combat.
- Accepted the horse-for-ogres bargain as costly but morally weighty.

- Told Alphie:
“Those horses bought lives. Still hurts. It should.”
- Recognised Alphie’s breakfast as care without needing explanation.
- Said “Good” over breakfast, which from him is basically a blessing.

Items:

- Still likely holding **Morak’s Potion of Heroism** with Morak’s permission “until the roads are safe,” unless returned before departure. This should be settled.

Kella Darkhope — Naomi

Former Zhentarim spy, now trial PC.

Core identity:

- Previously embedded in Nightstone to help create a Black Network foothold.
- Captured, negotiated with, disarmed, later rearmed as a trusted “specialist.”
- Helped rescue villagers.
- Chose not to ride south with Xolkin.
- Joined party under explicit terms.
- Dry, dangerous, observant, not soft, not a betrayal machine.

Party terms:

- Shared goals.
- Shared resources with records.
- No party theft.
- No secret Zhentarim messages.
- No selling party movements/plans to the Network.
- No PvP.
- Party does not treat Kella as prisoner or charity case.
- Dorrin does not trust her yet, but accepts terms.
- Wren wants the relationship playable, not stressful.
- Kella is Naomi’s character now, not Marcus’s secret betrayal device.

Recent key beats:

- Told the magistrate/ledger/horse story.
 - Revealed her father had been a caravan guard.
 - Alphie told her:
“Your father would be proud of that story. Every part of it. Especially the horse.”
 - She accepted breakfast as “praise” by saying it was “acceptable.”
 - Current status: at breakfast table, eating.
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4. Current quest: Goldenfields

Morak asked the party to travel to **Goldenfields** and tell **Miros Xelbrin** that his parents, **Lathan and Melantha Xelbrin**, died in Nightstone when the giants attacked.

Additional task:

- Bring **Rillix**, the Xelbrins' tressym, safely to Miros if possible.

Party chose Goldenfields after discussing all three options:

- Bryn Shander = dramatic, far north, harsh.
- Triboar = practical trade-road option.
- Goldenfields = emotionally fitting, food/hearth/rebuilding theme, Rillix quest, and strong fit for Wren/Dorin.

Current status:

- Goldenfields quest accepted.
 - Rillix found and secured.
 - Tower of Zephyros is due next source beat, the day after quest acceptance.
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5. Rillix the tressym

Location found:

- Xelbrin Residence, Area 4H.

Description:

- Ash-grey tressym with darker stripes, green-gold eyes, feathered wings.
- Suspicious, dignified, judgmental.
- Recognised or responded to the name **Miros** when Wren said it.

How secured:

- Alphie softened dried beef with water and offered it gently.
- Animal Handling roll: **14 + 0 = 14**, enough.
- Wren helped with gentle voice.
- Rillix took the beef, then glided to Wren's shoulder.

Current status:

- Alive.
- Secured.
- Most attached to Wren for now.

- Travelling to Goldenfields to be delivered to Miros.

Important clarification:

- Miros is **not present**. He lives in Goldenfields.
 - Rillix only reacted to the sound of Miros's name.
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6. Nightstone arc summary

Cloud giant attack

Cloud giants attacked Nightstone, dropped rocks, broke many roofs, killed Lady Velrosa and other villagers, and took the nightstone. This caused the villagers to flee north.

Goblins in Nightstone

Goblin looters spread through Nightstone. Named/source goblins included:

- Gwerk at 2D
- Larv and Snokk at 2E
- Pojo and Tot at 4C
- Blik and Flik at 4G
- Beedo and Vark at 5B
- Derp in 7B
- dead inn goblin in 8A, killed by Kella
- Gum-Gum in 8B
- Jilk at 9
- Longo and Yek in 10

Party did not necessarily clear every goblin room by room. The village was later stabilised broadly.

Kella / inn / Gum-Gum

Kella was found as a Zhentarim spy. Rather than simply executing or imprisoning her, Alphie structured terms.

Gum-Gum was interrogated and released after revealing the villagers were in Dripping Caves. Alphie gave her food and later publicly credited her by name before Hark.

This mattered in Hark negotiation.

Worgs

Two worgs in the square were killed. Alphie used Magic Missile during this fight.

Stable / Derp

At the stable, Derp hid in the hayloft and ambushed Dorrin, almost killing him with a critical arrow.

Alphie spotted Derp, avoided fire because of straw/horses, and killed Derp with a thrown dagger. Horses were secured and tacked properly.

Seven Snakes / Xolkin

Xolkin Alassandar arrived with the Seven Snakes to retrieve Kella and pursue Black Network goals.

Rather than fight, Alphie negotiated a temporary alliance.

Public oath later occurred in Nandar Keep, witnessed by:

- Alphie
- Dorrin
- Sydiri
- Lady Velrosa's body
- Xolkin
- Kella

Xolkin swore no banners, no claims, no recruitment, no Black Network business until villagers were rescued.

He kept the oath.

Nandar Keep / Sydiri

Party bridged the broken keep gap with temporary timber.

Found:

- Lady Velrosa dead and honoured.
- Sydiri Haunlar, alive.
- Torem Breck, broken arm.
- Alara Winterspell, alive.
- Kaelen Zam, head wound.

Dorrin healed Kaelen. Sydiri and Alara later joined the coalition. Torem and Kaelen remained as support.

Ear Seekers / Gurrash

The orc warband approached while party was preparing to ride to the caves.

Alphie chose to defend Nightstone rather than ride with orcs at their back.

Key defensive choices:

- raised western drawbridge;
- manned towers;
- used palisade/drawbridge as kill-zone;
- called Ardeep elves with Sydiri's horn;
- used Portent tactically;
- broke Norgra's Bless concentration;
- killed Gurrash with Fire Bolt.

Outcome:

- Gurrash dead.
- Norgra dead.
- Orc force routed.
- No allied deaths.
- Ardeep elves joined as temporary allies.

Rond / Ardeep elves

Rond Arrowhome and seven Ardeep scouts answered the horn and joined the fight.

After a nat 20 Persuasion, they agreed to help rescue captives from Dripping Caves.

They later returned to Ardeep but established a meaningful horn relationship:

- will answer for captives, children, or orcs;
- not for politics.

Dripping Caves rescue

Party went to Dripping Caves with a 16-person coalition:

- Alphie
- Dorrin
- Wren
- Kella
- Xolkin
- Joren
- Sydiri
- Alara
- Rond + seven Ardeep scouts

Plan:

- South mouth visible pressure.
- Chimney team extraction.

Chimney team included:

- Kella
- Rond
- Wren
- three elves

Alphie negotiated with Hark:

- nat 20 Persuasion.
- Hark accepted terms:
 - villagers out south mouth;
 - goblins out west stream tunnel;
 - no captives, no bones, no southward movement;
 - no arrows on goblins under safe passage.

Ogres were not part of Hark's bargain.

Alphie heard ogres in Giant:

“Why food walking?”

He understood they had not been told.

Alphie spoke Giant and offered six horses as food if they let villagers go.

Rolled nat 20.

Ogres accepted.

Outcome:

- Villagers rescued.
- Morak alive.
- Hark/goblins left under safe passage.
- Ogres remained in cave with six horses.
- No cave combat.
- Six Nightstone horses lost.

Return to Nightstone

Morak was told the truth plainly:

- giants attacked;
- Lady Velrosa died;
- goblins looted;
- worgs killed;
- orcs defeated;
- Black Network involved under oath;
- Morak's belongings were safeguarded.

Morak's goods were returned.

Party helped Nightstone begin recovery.

7. Nightstone recovery and obligations

Returned to Morak

Returned:

- chain mail
- dwarven helm
- 45 gp
- two 100 gp gems
- dented silver jug
- cracked hourglass
- cook's utensils
- frying pan
- iron pot
- lantern and oil
- saffron and cloves

Potion of Heroism:

- Morak allowed Dorrin to keep it temporarily until roads are safe. Should be reconciled before leaving.

Horse restitution

Six horses were lost to the ogres:

- 4 draft horses
- 2 riding horses

Market-ish value:

- 4 draft $\times$ 50 gp = 200 gp
- 2 riding $\times$ 75 gp = 150 gp

Alphie agreed to **500 gp restitution** because these were working animals/livelihoods, not just numbers in a ledger.

Paid:

- 25 gp immediately.

Remaining:

- 475 gp owed.

Documents:

- sealed Roane restitution note;
- relief letters to House Roane / Daggerford contacts for:
 - replacement horses;
 - timber;
 - grain;
 - bridge supplies;
 - nails/canvas;
 - labour/support.

Witnessed by:

- Morak
- Dorrin
- Sydiri

Cider

Alphie gave two casks of Roane cider for Nightstone supper:

- 1 × dry apple cider
- 1 × spiced apple cider

Morak used it carefully for morale, not drunkenness.

Remaining wagon cider:

- 1 × 20L Roane dry apple cider
- 1 × 20L Roane pear-apple cider
- 6 × 750ml sealed sample bottles

Party names request

Alphie asked Morak:

“When we ride on, if any traveller asks who rode in, tell them four names: Alphie Roane, Wren, Dorrin Stonebrook and Kella. Not heroically. Just by name. That’s all I’d ask. Not for me. For my father.”

Morak agreed:

“Not heroes. Names.”

8. Current Alphie inventory

Personal gear

- Spellbook
- Component pouch
- Wand of Magic Detection / Detect Magic focus, if using D&D Beyond item
- Quarterstaff
- 2 daggers
- Scholar’s pack / backpack
- Book
- Calligrapher’s supplies
- Parchment
- Ink bottle
- Quills
- Dragonchess set
- Fine/noble clothes

- Robe / spare robe
- Fur warm clothes
- Signet ring
- Scroll of pedigree / noble papers
- Roane wax/seal materials
- Ledger book
- Goldenfields letter for Miros Xelbrin
- Roane relief letters / horse restitution documentation

Coin

After horse restitution deposit:

0 gp personal coin on hand, unless D&D Beyond coin is being treated as current and reconciled later.

Wagon food before breakfast

Previous exact stock:

- 24 hard travel biscuits
- 2 small sacks dried apples
- 1 bundle smoked ham strips, about 4 person-days
- 1 bundle dried beef, about 4 person-days
- 12 oat cakes
- 1 small sack walnuts, about 2 lb
- 1 half-full honey jar
- 1 salt pouch
- 4 full waterskins
- 1 small sack horse oats, about 1 day for remaining mounts

Breakfast used:

- some pear-apple cider;
- some apples/dried apples;
- some walnuts;
- a little honey;
- some smoked ham strips;
- water.

Need exact deduction if desired later, but not yet fully costed.

Wagon travel gear

- 4 bedrolls / blankets
 - 1 spare wool blanket
 - 1 cooking pot
 - 4 tin cups
 - 4 wooden bowls
 - flint and steel
 - 1 lantern
 - 1 oil flask
 - 1 × 50 ft hemp rope
 - 8 spare parchment sheets
 - ink bottle
 - 3 quills
 - sealing wax
 - Roane signet
 - ledger book
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9. Survivor gathering / relationship scene

That night after the rescue, there was a small gathering in Morak's inn.

Tone:

- quiet survivor gathering;
- cider in small cups;
- no wild rowdiness;
- grief and humour together.

Game played:

- "Truth or tale."

Alphie told story:

- age 14, locked in dark cider cellar with angry goose, shattered lantern, and weeping Waterdhavian tax clerk.
- Goose survived and was named Alphie.
- Dorrin toasted:
"To Alphie the goose. May his wrath remain in Waterdeep."

Wren told story:

- performed a love ballad so badly the groom called off the wedding, the bride thanked her, and bride's mother paid double.

- It was true.

Kella told story:

- age 17, hired to steal a magistrate's ledger.
- Found stolen widow payments for caravan guards.
- Stole ledger, strongbox, and magistrate's horse.
- Delivered ledger to employer, coin to widows, sold horse back to magistrate under false name.
- Magistrate later hired her to find the thief.
- Wren spotted the hidden emotional point and asked why she gave coin to widows.
- Kella revealed:
"Because my father was a caravan guard."

Alphie told Kella:

"Your father would be proud of that story. Every part of it. Especially the horse."

Wren said:

"Some stories are hiding from themselves."

Toasts:

- To unlikely company.
- To company that keeps terms.
- To stories that survive the day.
- To accurate files.

Emotional state:

- Wren and Alphie have increasing warmth/chemistry.
 - Kella and Alphie have sharp, charged, morally complex curiosity.
 - Kella and Wren have a potentially rich trust/distrust relationship.
 - Dorrin sees more than he says.
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10. Relationship readings

Wren and Alphie

Closest emotional warmth. Slow-burn possible, healthy, trust-based, if Talia wants that.

Key dynamic:

- Wren sees the hidden part of stories.
- Alphie sees her seeing.
- Gentle, sincere, emotionally safe.

Kella and Alphie

Charged, dangerous, curious. More tension than safety.

Key dynamic:

- Alphie does not reduce her to spy/villain.
- Kella sees his oath-keeping as operationally and morally disruptive.
- Could be a dramatic romance, rivalry, or deep trust arc if Naomi wants it.

Dorrin and Alphie

Brotherly/moral anchor relationship.

Key dynamic:

- Dorrin respects Alphie but will not flatter him out of moral discomfort.
- He holds Alphie to costly goodness.

Morak and Alphie

Practical trust. Morak respects truth, restitution, and records.

Sydiri and Alphie

Commander-to-commander respect. She sees him as witness and ally, not authority over Nightstone.

Rond and Alphie

Respectful diplomatic bond. Rond will not travel with party, but Ardeep connection matters.

11. Important NPC statuses

Morak Ur'gray

Alive. Running Nightstone recovery. Gave Goldenfields quest. Holds restitution note. Trusts Alphie cautiously and practically.

Sydiri Haunlar

Alive. Acting security authority. Trusts party. Maintains Nightstone order.

Alara Winterspell

Alive. Young guard. Brave. Helped rescue/defence.

Torem Breck

Alive. Broken arm. Gatehouse/watch support.

Kaelen Zam

Alive. Recovered from head wound after Dorrin's healing.

Lady Velrosa Nandar

Dead. Honoured in keep. Needs proper funeral/rites.

Xolkin Alassandar

Alive. Left with Seven Snakes. Kept oath. Still dangerous. Still emotionally tied to Kella.

Joren, Pell, Maks, Tessa, Hask

Seven Snakes members used during defence. Left with Xolkin unless Marcus later threads Joren back in.

Rond Arrowhome

Alive. Returned to Ardeep. Horn relationship established.

Hark

Alive. Goblin boss. Left by west stream tunnel. Not good, but kept terms.

Gum-Gum

Alive. Released with food. Publicly credited by Alphie.

Two ogres

Alive in Dripping Caves. Fed six horses. Not pursuing now; future danger possible.

Miros Xelbrin

In Goldenfields. Adult son of Lathan and Melantha. Party must tell him his parents died and bring Rillix.

Rillix

Tressym, alive, now secured with Wren.

12. Website / documents

A campaign website exists and has been upgraded multiple times.

Latest useful version:

- **Alfie D&D Website V3 — Chapter 2 / Goldenfields**
- Includes:
 - Bookmark 5 dashboard.
 - Chapter 2 prep hub.
 - Goldenfields quick reference.
 - Special NPC cards.
 - Goldenfields defence tracker.
 - Rules/prep audit.
 - Inventory, NPC, timeline, quest tracker.
 - Searchable embedded document reader.

A contrast-fixed Level 3 Coalition Statbook was made earlier due to dark table headers.

Level 4 character sheets were made for:

- Wren
- Dorrin
- Kella

Kella was rebuilt as a playable **Human Rogue 4 / Thief** for Naomi, rather than remaining Spy stat block.

13. Open mechanical/rules questions

1. **Ruleset mismatch**
 - Table had been 2014.
 - D&D Beyond screenshots show 2024 Wizard/Evocation.
 - Must decide before next combat.
 2. **Alphie build**
 - Earlier table: School of Divination.
 - D&D Beyond: Evocation / 2024 traits.
 - Needs reconciliation.
 3. **Kella build**
 - PDF made as Human Rogue 4 / Thief.
 - Naomi should approve/adjust before next session.
 4. **Potion of Heroism**
 - Still with Dorrin by Morak's permission?
 - Return before leaving or record as formally lent.
 5. **Horse restitution**
 - Track 475 gp debt.
 - Future Roane response pending.
 6. **Tower of Zephyros timing**
 - Source-correct: day after Morak's quest accepted.
 - Party has accepted Goldenfields, so next day or immediately after breakfast if the day has advanced.
 7. **Goldenfields special NPC assignment**
 - Chapter 2 likely needs special NPC handling.
 - Website has suggested cards.
 - Decide when arriving.
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14. Immediate next scene options

We are at breakfast. The party can:

1. Finish breakfast quietly.
2. Reconcile rules/builds OOC.
3. Return or formally borrow the Potion of Heroism.
4. Say goodbye to Morak/Sydir/Nightstone.
5. Begin the day leading toward **Tower of Zephyros**.
6. Fast-forward to the tower appearing.

Most source-correct move:

After breakfast, Morak ensures Goldenfields letter and Rillix are ready. Nightstone villagers continue recovery. The party prepares to leave. Then, according to source timing, **the Tower of Zephyros appears the day after Morak's quest is accepted**, offering transport toward the chosen destination — Goldenfields.

15. Best restart prompt for Marcus

When resuming, say:

“We resume at Bookmark 6: morning at Morak's inn, after Alphie quietly made breakfast for Wren, Kella, and Dorrin. Goldenfields has been chosen, Rillix is secured with Wren, the party is level 4 and long-rested, Kella is now Naomi's trial PC, and Tower of Zephyros is the next source beat. Before moving on, we need to reconcile Alfie's 2014 Divination build versus the D&D Beyond 2024 Evocation sheet, and decide whether Dorrin returns or keeps Morak's Potion of Heroism. Then we can move toward Zephyros.”

That's the bookmark.